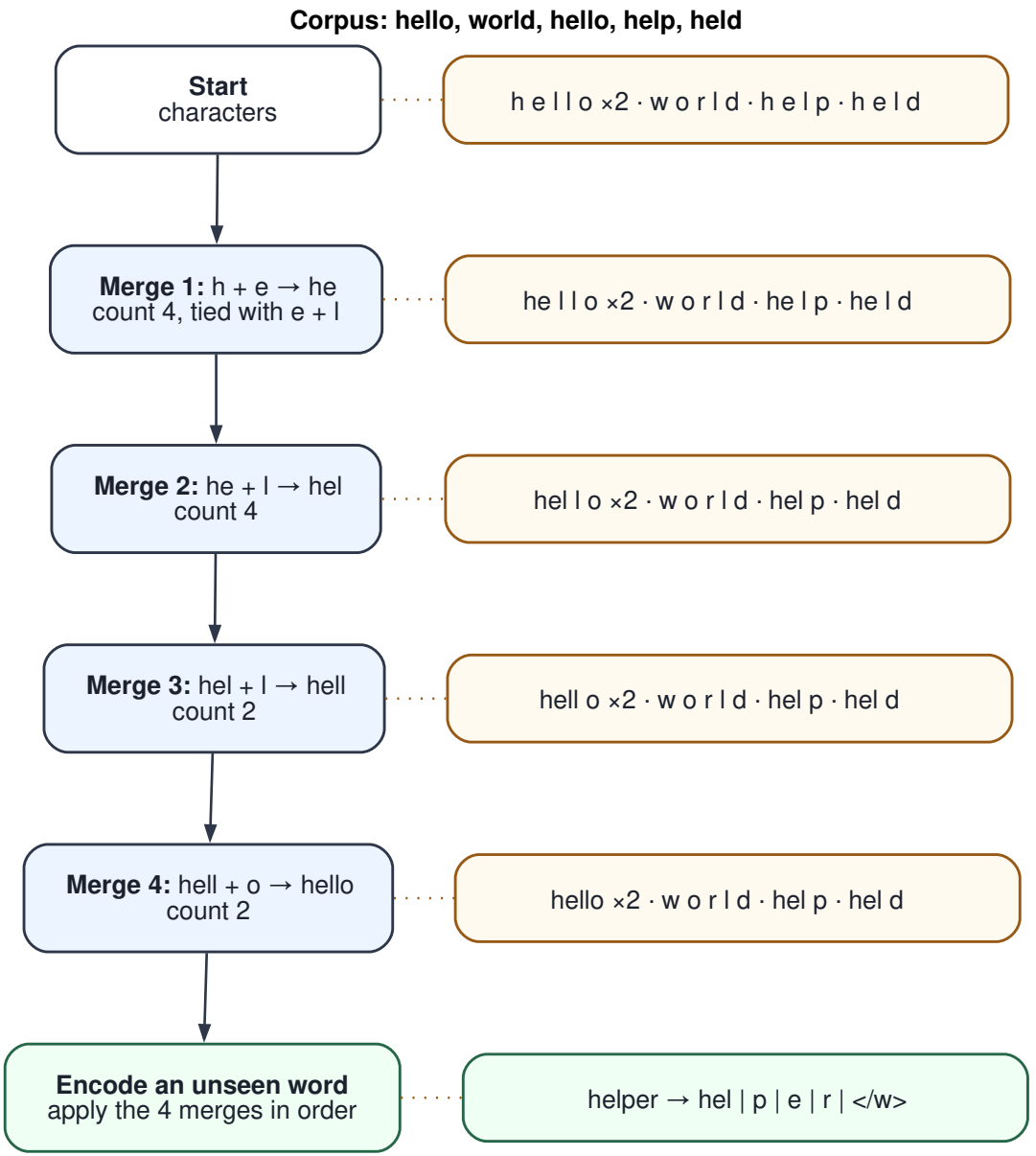
Corpus: hello, world, hello, help, held
Start
characters
h e l l o ×2 · w o r l d · h e l p · h e l d
Merge 1: h + e → he
count 4, tied with e + l
he l l o ×2 · w o r l d · he l p · he l d
Merge 2: he + l → hel
count 4
hel l o ×2 · w o r l d · hel p · hel d
Merge 3: hel + l → hell
count 2
hell o ×2 · w o r l d · hel p · hel d
Merge 4: hell + o → hello
count 2
hello ×2 · w o r l d · hel p · hel d
Encode an unseen word
apply the 4 merges in order
helper → hel | p | e | r | </w>